

EMULATION VS. VIRTUALISATION VS. SIMULATION

What are emulation, simulation and virtualisation? Is there a relation? Or some form of differentiation? Here we attempt a disambiguation. Let's start with an examination of virtualisation.

Whenever you encounter the topic of Emulation, Virtualisation is not far behind — and for good reason. These two concepts are often tightly linked together.

To understand their bond, let's first understand what virtualisation is. The root word here is virtual, which means something that isn't real, but has the same effect or role. To virtualise something then is to create a virtual version of it in such a way as to have the same effect as the original thing — whatever it may be.

Virtualisation then is the process of creating a virtual version of something that can be used in a manner similar to the real thing.

Let us look at an example that might not directly come to mind when you think of virtualisation, and that is virtual memory. As you may be aware,